

Apple-dom

I'LL ADMIT that the very first time I came across an Apple device, I was pretty clueless about the device and its ecosystem. Up until that point I'd only heard of the iOS operating system and the prowess of the device from friends and read up on articles that echoed the same. There was nothing out of the ordinary about Apple products because every other company on the surface of the earth went about marketing their devices in the same manner. Every article you'd read would mostly have a positive spin and this was way before clickbait became a norm on the Internet. So when I did finally get my hands on an iPod Touch I could feel the excitement. This was a super expensive device that only one person in my social circle had owned. They had to be imported back then and experiencing an Apple device after having read a lot about it for so long just ... felt right. It was a feeling that I'd rarely experience again in my life, one that would send a bucketload of endorphins coursing through my veins.

Alas, that experience was short-lived. My friend had brought his iPod over for a reason, to Jailbreak it! He and I were like minded; we both loved to read about tech and tinker with new devices just for the thrill of it. He wanted to check out the famed Cydia and play around with a few things. My memory deceives the exact purpose for which we wanted to Jailbreak the device. This wasn't the first time we'd tried to subvert protective mechanisms. Every friend with a computer was doing the same, if you know what I mean (*wink*). There was no way to get games legally back then. Few of us were even experienced with hex-editors and memory editors, so Jailbreaking should have been easy.

Little did we know how excruciatingly painful that experience would turn out to be. By the end of the day, we'd soft-bricked and run into more bootloops than the limits that high-school arithmetic had taught us. Thankfully, Apple's documentation was pretty straight forward about the whole recovery process so we could try and fail without worry. We didn't manage to get the unit jailbroken that day, in fact, it would take us a few more days before we'd read up enough to get all the steps right. That's when we came across the numerous online posts that had criticised

the bejesus out of Apple and its ecosystem. In a way, that experience is what probably made me aware of how restrictive the whole ecosystem was. The more we read about Apple with the aim to jailbreak the device, the more vitriol we'd come across. For many years, I could never figure why people would tolerate such a thing. It was certainly a company that led the charge when it came to innovation but the price that one had to pay seemed a bit too much. The most recent example of this 'cost' would be the T2 coprocessor that Apple is shipping with new MacBooks. If the unit is serviced then it needs to be booted via a licensed Apple diagnostic software or you run a chance to brick it. This is literally the technological manifestation of the domination fetish. People pay, exorbitant amounts that too, to be dominated by the company that made the device. It's as if you're never the owner of your Apple smartphone but a serf serving in the dark courts of Apple-dom where there lurks an Apple genius in every corner whose slender fingers fidget over leather whips that they're eager to crack at you.

brrrrr

The Apple devices have some of the most powerful SoCs (that's soon to change) among all smartphones so I'd naturally gravitate towards them, but then I'd remember what the privilege entailed and I'd stay away. Most people who know me are aware of my aversion to all things Apple. Even Robert has known about this for many years. I don't know what got into him this month but he's decided that I shall be forced to endure all those nightmares all over again. He has arranged for an iPhone XS MAX for me to use as my daily driver from here on out, and I am not allowed to go back to my beloved Android devices, no matter what the circumstances! His real intentions shall forever be shrouded in mystery, but as far as I'm concerned, he's slowly starting to appear as that Apple Genius whose slender fingers ... you get the drift.

Anyway, since I'm being forced to endure something I hate, I'm going to take it out on you folks and rant a lot more as a prisoner of Apple-dom. I don't see myself joining the dark side any time soon, but you never know.... **d**



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